

BenQ MP612c

LCD TVs Need Not Sweat

Projectors can go where no LCD or Plasma screen can—they can give large screen areas for a comparatively cheap price. BenQ's MP612c is one such projector that was sent to us for testing.

The design of the BenQ is very stylish and it's also very rigid at the same time. The top of the projector has a glossy finish and the quality of buttons is very good too. The quality of the zoom and focus rings, feels cheap and is not as great as the external design though. There is a fan at the front of the project, which blows loads of hot air out of the unit.

Although there is no DVI port, connections can be made through VGA, S-video and composite connectors. The remote control gives you all the controls you get on the projector itself. The interface is excel-

lent and only takes a few minutes to get used to.

Installing the projector and then setting it up is also simple. The BenQ 612c can easily handle resolutions up to 1280 x 1024. It's also very easy to display on a large area. The default brightness is high to begin with, and the settings let you increase it further. Colours aren't very saturated, but they are still pretty good. There is no flickering of any kind, but increasing the brightness can be a little strenuous on the eyes. There are modes for different types of media as well as custom profiles that can be customised by the user. There's also a digital zoom to zoom and pan into a scene, which is really useful in places when you're trying to explain details in an image, for example.

The price of the BenQ MP612c is around Rs



39,990, which makes it one of the more affordable projectors of the lot. For this price, it actually makes good sense to buy one. The crippling problem with projectors is the reliability, because of the heat generated. The same can be found in the BenQ MP612c. It gets very hot and running it for long hours doesn't seem to be a good idea. It might be alright if you want to use it for watching movies every once in a while and of course perfect for official presentations and slideshows.

Specifications:
Native resolution: 800 x 600,

Lamp life: 4000 hours (Economy mode), Dimensions: 23.9 x 10.6 x 25.1 cm, Weight: 2.5 kgs.

Contact: BenQ India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 1800-22-0808
E-mail: sales.enquiryin@benq.com
Web site: www.benq.co.in
Price: Rs 39,990

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Antec NSK4400

Antec's Attempt At Bringing Quality To Entry Level Cabinets



Antec is well known mostly for the P180, P182 and the Antec 900 cases, which are high-end enthusiast level cases that compete with the best from CoolerMaster and the likes. The NSK4400 is an entry level mini-tower case for desktop PCs, which target cases from the lesser-known brands.

The quality of the cabinet is pretty good. The metal work is thin, but is sturdy and doesn't flex a lot under pressure or weight. The biggest dilemma is when you don't read the manual that comes with the cabinet! This is a cabinet opens from the top first. Once that's done, the side panels can be removed. Two thumbscrews are to be removed before opening the cabinet.

There's enough space for three optical drives, three hard drives and two floppy drives or other panels of the same size. The hard drive bays have bits of padding to reduce vibrations. For cooling, there is a 120-mm fan attached to the back, with a speed switch that acts as a good exhaust. There is an air guide attached to the

side cover of the cabinet that directs air to the processor. The guide can be removed and an 80-mm fan can be fixed. There is provision for a fan in the front under the drives. The rear expansion panels pop out easily and can be snapped back into place if you choose to remove any cards or change positions. That way you have no open slots in your cabinet letting dust in.

The cabinet doesn't look stylish, but it's elegant and straightforward. Even though it's small, it has a very clean flat look to it. The front face of the cabinet is sturdy without any loose bits from the removable panels. There are two USB ports with an extended cable that can be connected to your motherboard.

The price for the Antec NSK4400 is Rs 2,285. It's definitely one of the cheapest Antec cabinets we've seen, but the lack of a power supply makes it not-so-cheap. If you are building an entry level system, and you want a sturdy cabinet with decent cooling, then the slightly overpriced NSK4400 is worth it.

Specifications:
Supports Mini-ATX and Standard ATX form factor, Dimensions: 42 x 20 x 42 cm

Contact: Cyber Space Abacus Pvt Ltd
Phone: 9884021688
E-mail: vinod@antecindia.com
Web site: www.antecindia.com
Price: Rs 2,285

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Trend Micro Internet Security Pro

Slightly Overloaded System Security Guardian

Trend Micro Internet Security Pro is an all-in-one security solution that has been developed to keep your PC trouble free by taking care of all possible threats of all kinds.

If the suite finds that your system does not have enough memory to run it, it warns you. If there are other anti-spyware programs such as Spybot for example, it will uninstall it if you allow it to.

Once installed, it's a good idea to register the program as a few additional features are given access to. Trend Micro Internet Security also scans Windows for any vulnerability fixed that you may have not updated to.

There are a few features like Data Theft Protection, which stops any credit card number or personal information from being sent out

through instant messengers for example. You can also add information to be protected. There are some other features for stopping any unwanted access to your PC. Any new computers that appear on your LAN can be scanned after every few minutes and you can choose to stop them from accessing your PC—this is useful if you're on a public LAN or WAN. The Parental Controls are also pretty advanced in the sense that you can simply check the boxes of the types of content you want to block. You can also manually make changes to add or remove sites from the block list.

The memory consumption of the antivirus is pretty high and we recorded around 55–60 MB on idle state. Even after you stop the suite, there are still a few running services consuming some memory like most other suites of its kind. A



screenshot-filled manual with an explanation of features is provided with the software, but the software itself is fairly easy to use after a few minutes.

Trend Micro Internet Security Pro is just another security suite, which doesn't really stand out among the rest. It does the job of handling viruses and security threats well but is a little heavy on the system. The price tag of Rs. 2,760 is asking a lot, especially when there are free alternatives available online.

Specifications:
Windows XP / Vista supported. Requires 350 MB to 1 GB of free disk space with 1 GB of memory recommended

Web site: www.trendmicro.com
Price: Rs. 2,760

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Steelseries Siberia Neckband

Pain In The Neck



The Siberia Neckband is a product from Steelseries for the professional gamer, or so it seems. Steelseries has played an active role in the professional gaming arena and tied up with clans and communities.

If you think wearing a headphone with a stretch-

able strap that attaches to the back of your head is comfortable, you're wrong. Sure, for people with smaller heads, it should work fine, but anyone with a larger head will find it too tight or hanging from the top of your ears. You'll also notice that they start slipping back from

the back of your head and adjusting it from time to time can be irritating.

The sound quality of the Siberia isn't too shabby. It lacks the extreme low bass, so isn't ideal for music or movies. For gaming, it should do fine. These phones do not distort or lose quality at high volumes, and the volume can get pretty high. These are open headphones and as they don't hug the side of your face properly, a lot of the sound leaks out.

There's a flexible microphone that retracts into the headphone too. It performs pretty good quality audio recording. There's an adapter for the Xbox360 supplied with it and a volume control too. The headphones are built well and the look is appealing.

Good audio recording quality and an easily adjustable microphone are the good points of the

Siberia Neckband but even then, a price of Rs 5,999 is a lot to ask for. There are much cheaper solutions without the Steelseries tag and slightly inferior, which do a better job without any of the discomfort.

Specifications:
Headphone: Frequency response: 18–28,000 Hz, Impedance: 40 Hz, Microphone: Frequency response: 80–15,000 Hz

Contact: Vstreet Netserve Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 079-40020127
E-mail: sales@v-street.net
Web site: www.steelseries.com
Price: Rs 5,999

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★